

SERIES 2

Piano

for leisure



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Australi
Music
Examin
Board

Grade I



Piano for Leisure

GRADE 1

"You are the music while the music lasts."

– T.S. Eliot

(1888 - 1965)

Foreword

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Published by Australian Music Examinations Board ACN 102 374 587 ABN 27 102 374 587.

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ISMN 979-0-720110-51-6

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Preface

As part of its commitment to excellence in piano pedagogy, the AMEB is proud to announce the publication of the *Piano for Leisure Series* 2 grade books. This series of publications offers a stimulating and contemporary collection of works for enjoyment and study.

As editorial consultant John Terry points out in his preliminary note, the *Piano for Leisure* syllabus is designed to encourage musical exploration, imagination and development. It opens up opportunities to those who may one day contemplate a professional career in music as a performer as well as to those who are content to entertain themselves and their friends and family. A common thread which runs through the experiences of all those who use the *Piano for Leisure* syllabus and graded materials is a firm conviction in the power of music to create pleasure, enjoyment and to stimulate creativity.

A key to *Piano for Leisure's* success is the attention which is given to repertoire. John Terry has compiled a series of pieces which aims at maximum stylistic diversity while ensuring that every piece is aesthetically and pedagogically rewarding. Leafing through these books is like exploring a treasure chest. Teachers and students will find beloved classical works such as Albéniz's *Malagueña* or Bach's *Invention*, as well as popular 'salon' pieces such as Paderewski's *Menuet célèbre* or Rubinstein's *Mélodie*. Orchestral transcriptions, such as Khachaturian's *Sabre dance* and Offenbach's *Barcarolle* are also featured. Jazz and popular styles are well served with works such as Desmond's *Take five*, Gershwin's *I got rhythm* and Winifred Atwell's *Dixie boogie*. Film themes are represented with works such as Legrand's *The summer knows*, Myers's *Cavatina* (from *The deer hunter*) and the music from *Harry Potter and the chamber of secrets*. And as always, the AMEB continues its support for Australian composition with works as diverse as Elissa Milne's *Safari* and *Groovy movie*, Carl Vine's *Red blues*, Martin Wesley-Smith's *Griff's riffs* and Judy Bailey's *The sprightly ones*.

As usual, performance notes at the end of each volume identify the main areas for attention in each work and discuss problems of interpretation. The performance notes are an invaluable resource especially for teachers.

The AMEB has been particularly grateful to draw on the significant experience of two highly accomplished musicians in the preparation of these volumes. Dr John Terry brings tremendous experience as a performing artist of great stylistic diversity to the selection and editing of these works. Dr Timothy Stevens similarly brings insights developed through an impressive academic and performance career to the writing of performance notes which are insightful, entertaining and sympathetic to the demands of works in classical and popular styles.

SUPPORT MATERIAL

This *Piano for Leisure Series 2* Grade Book is designed to be used with and to complement the *Piano for Leisure* syllabus. The AMEB's *Piano for Leisure Series 2 Recordings and Handbooks* will also be of interest. Specifically designed to assist students with the preparation of these works for examination, the handbooks contain a wealth of information about the historical, biographical and interpretative 'landscapes' of each of the works. They are also enhanced by the addition of CD recordings of all the works in the *Piano for Leisure Series 2* Grade Books, performed by distinguished pianists.

Sight Reading, a carefully graded programme for the development and practice of this important skill, was released in 2004 and will be of great interest to users of the *Piano for Leisure Series 2* Grade Books.

Candidates and teachers should always be familiar with the requirements of the AMEB's *Manual of Syllabuses*.

JOHN WERETKA
General Editor

From the Editorial Consultant

Welcome to *Piano for Leisure Series 2!*

I do hope you enjoy the stylistically diverse selection of repertoire that has been chosen for this series. Each Grade Book contains pieces that enable choice of 'classical' performance pieces, more popular or jazz-related ones, or indeed an ideal eclectic collection. With this latter notion in mind, a student sitting for Grade 5 could, for example, choose a set of three pieces comprising a two-part *Invention* by J.S. Bach, theme music from the film *The chamber of secrets* and a special and musically interesting arrangement of *Waltzing Matilda*!

Piano for Leisure offers encouragement for a full range of interests and aspirations in music. It is as much for those who want to pursue a career in music as it is for those who are playing at home for themselves. While I hope you will find enormous enjoyment in this music, I have also planned this selection as a carefully sequenced programme containing strong educational components. You are encouraged to learn about performance issues, the manner in which pieces are structured, historical issues, the harmony underlying a piece and so on. The Grade Books are accompanied by performance notes which address performance, rehearsal and learning issues. The series of handbooks contains notes that provide a more thorough and general 'landscape' for any piece under study and offers material which you can use to help you prepare to address the general knowledge component of practical examinations. The handbooks also contain splendid CD recordings of each of the pieces. The handbooks are an extremely valuable resource and will enable you to obtain a thorough and well-rounded view of whichever pieces you choose to perform.

Musicians have found pleasure at the keyboard for centuries. May it give you as much pleasure as it has to the countless numbers it has always served. It gives me much joy to think that students and teachers will find playing the music in this series of *Piano for Leisure* a challenging, educational, useful, creative and life-enriching experience.

DR JOHN TERRY

About the Editorial Consultant

Pianist, composer and educator Dr John Terry is one of Australia's leading musicians. Dr Terry holds a Doctorate in Creative Arts from the University of Wollongong, a Master of Music degree in Music Education and Composition from Adelaide University and graduate performing qualifications from the Royal College of Music, Royal Academy of Music, Guildhall School of Music and the Trinity College of Music, London. He brings a vast array of experiences in piano literature to *Piano for Leisure*. He has toured with several jazz groups, headed new music ensembles and received commissions for works for piano and orchestra. He has established a successful reputation as a composer, particularly in the areas of instrumental music and music theatre for young people. He has a life-long interest in the theatre and at one stage toured as a puppeteer with the renowned Marionette Theatre of Australia's *Tintookies*. Dr Terry is also a writer and visual artist. In 2001 one of his multi-media music-artworks was officially recognised by the United Nations, marking the Year of Volunteers. He has been a full-time lecturer at several Australian universities including the Sydney Conservatorium of Music, University of Adelaide, University of Newcastle, and the James Cook University of North Queensland. In this capacity he has taught in the areas of performance, theoretical studies, composition and music education.

Dr Terry was the editorial consultant for *Piano for Leisure Series 1* and is the author for the *Piano for Leisure Series 2 Recordings & Handbooks*.

No 1
Rag time

Christopher Norton
(born 1953)

Rag tempo ♩ = ca 144

The musical score is written for piano in 4/4 time, key of D major. It consists of four systems of two staves each (treble and bass clef). The first system (measures 1-4) begins with a mezzo-piano (*mp*) dynamic. The melody in the treble clef features triplet eighth notes and a quintuplet eighth note. The bass clef provides a simple harmonic accompaniment with eighth notes. The second system (measures 5-8) ends with a repeat sign and the word *Fine*. The third system (measures 9-12) starts with a mezzo-forte (*mf*) dynamic and includes a crescendo (*cresc.*) marking. The fourth system (measures 13-16) also begins with *mf* and concludes with a *Da capo al Fine* instruction. Fingerings are indicated by numbers 1-5 above or below notes. Pedal points are marked with a square symbol in the bass clef at measures 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, and 16.

No 2
Dance

from *Gyermekeknek* Book 2 Sz 42

Béla Bartók
(1881 – 1945)

Allegro moderato $\text{♩} = 120$

The musical score is presented in three systems, each containing a treble and bass staff. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 2/4. The tempo is marked 'Allegro moderato' with a metronome indication of 120 beats per minute. The first system (measures 1-4) begins with a piano (*p*) dynamic. The second system (measures 5-8) is marked mezzo-piano (*mp*). The third system (measures 9-12) continues with the same dynamic. The bass staff throughout features a consistent eighth-note accompaniment pattern. The treble staff contains a melodic line with various ornaments, including triplets and slurs, and includes fingerings such as 3, 2, 4, and 5. The score concludes with a final measure in the third system.

17 *calando*

3 2

1 2 3 4 5

21 , a tempo

più p

1 2 3 4 5

1 5

3

25 *poco ritard.*

2 2 3 2

p

1 4

30 *smorzando* a tempo rall.

perdendosi

pp

1 5

No 3
The ambling armadillo

from 'A' is for
to Max Olding and Pamela Page in admiration

Robert Keane
(born 1948)

Not too fast $\text{♩} = 100$

1 2 1 5 1 2

4 2 1 3 3 1 1 2 1 1

7 3 3 1 3

10 5 1 5 3 1 4 2 5 3 1

13

Musical score for measures 13-15. The piece is in G major (one sharp). Measure 13 starts with a mezzo-forte (*mf*) dynamic. The right hand plays a series of eighth notes ascending from G4 to D5, while the left hand plays a steady eighth-note bass line from G3 to D4. In measure 14, the right hand continues the eighth-note pattern, and the left hand has a half rest. Measure 15 features a whole note chord of G4 and D5 in the right hand and a half note chord of G3 and D4 in the left hand.

16

Musical score for measures 16-18. The piece is in G major. Measure 16 begins with a piano (*p*) dynamic. The right hand plays a half note G4, followed by eighth notes A4, B4, and C5, all beamed together. The left hand plays a half note G3. Measure 17 has a half rest in the right hand and eighth notes A3, B3, and C4 in the left hand. Measure 18 features a half note G4 in the right hand and eighth notes A3, B3, and C4 in the left hand. A first fingering (1) is indicated for the final G4.

19

Musical score for measures 19-20. The piece is in G major. Measure 19 contains a triplet of eighth notes (G4, A4, B4) in the right hand and a half note G3 in the left hand. Measure 20 starts with a forte (*f*) dynamic. The right hand has a half rest, while the left hand plays eighth notes A3, B3, and C4. A second ending bracket spans the final two measures, leading to a final chord of G4 and D5. Fingerings 5, 4, and 1 are marked for the right hand, and 2, 1, and 5 are marked for the left hand.

No 4
Groovy movie

Elissa Milne
(born 1967)

Swinging ♩ = 126

1 2 1 2 1

f

5 *legato*

6 1 2

4 3 2 1 3

11 4 5 3 4 2 3 1

16 *mf*

5 2 1

21 1 2 *p*

1 2 1 2 5

No 5
Ol' rockin' chair blues

Martha Mier
(born 1936)

Unhurried, slow blues swing⁽¹⁾ ♩ = 80

The musical score is written for piano in 4/4 time. It consists of 13 measures. The tempo is 'Unhurried, slow blues swing' at 80 beats per minute. The dynamics range from mezzo-piano (mp) to mezzo-forte (mf). The key signature has one flat (B-flat). The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, ties, and fingerings.

Measure 1: *mp*. Treble clef: whole rest. Bass clef: quarter notes G2, A2, B2, C3. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 2: Treble clef: whole rest. Bass clef: quarter notes C3, B2, A2, G2. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 3: Treble clef: quarter notes D3, E3, F3, G3. Fingering: 1, 5, 3. Bass clef: quarter notes G2, A2, B2, C3. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 4: Treble clef: quarter notes G3, F3, E3, D3. Fingering: 5, 3, 2, 1. Bass clef: quarter notes C3, B2, A2, G2. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 5: Treble clef: quarter notes D3, E3, F3, G3. Fingering: 2, 1, 5, 3. Bass clef: quarter notes G2, A2, B2, C3. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 6: Treble clef: quarter notes G3, F3, E3, D3. Fingering: 1, 5, 3, 2. Bass clef: quarter notes C3, B2, A2, G2. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 7: Treble clef: quarter notes D3, E3, F3, G3. Fingering: 5, 3, 2, 1. Bass clef: quarter notes G2, A2, B2, C3. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 8: Treble clef: quarter notes G3, F3, E3, D3. Fingering: 5, 3, 2, 1. Bass clef: quarter notes C3, B2, A2, G2. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 9: Treble clef: quarter notes D3, E3, F3, G3. Fingering: 5, 3, 2, 1. Bass clef: quarter notes G2, A2, B2, C3. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 10: Treble clef: quarter notes G3, F3, E3, D3. Fingering: 2, 1, 5, 3. Bass clef: quarter notes C3, B2, A2, G2. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 11: Treble clef: quarter notes D3, E3, F3, G3. Fingering: 3, 2, 1, 5. Bass clef: quarter notes G2, A2, B2, C3. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 12: Treble clef: quarter notes G3, F3, E3, D3. Fingering: 1, 5, 3, 2. Bass clef: quarter notes C3, B2, A2, G2. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

Measure 13: Treble clef: quarter notes D3, E3, F3, G3. Fingering: 3, 2, 1, 5. Bass clef: quarter notes G2, A2, B2, C3. Fingering: 5, 2, 1, 2.

(1) ♩ = $\frac{1}{3}$ ♩

16

19

22

25

27 *ritard.*

No 6
TV zombie
 from *Bogus boogies*

Sonny Chua
 (born 1967)

Quite slow but Rhythmical and jazzy ⁽¹⁾ ♩ = 80 drained vegie

mf

legato

louder

softer

(1) ♩ = ♩³

13

4

1

5

3

sf

8^{ba}...

1 3 3 1

1 2 5

16

mp

5

2

4

2

4

2

19

4

p

1 2 1 2 3

1 3 4

No 7
Garage sale

Pamela Wedgwood
(born 1947)

Heavy rock ♩ = 108

The musical score is written for piano and bass in 4/4 time, marked 'Heavy rock' with a tempo of 108 beats per minute. The key signature has one flat (Bb). The score is divided into four systems, each with a measure number (1, 4, 7, 10) at the start of the first staff.

System 1 (Measures 1-3): The piano part (treble clef) has rests. The bass part (bass clef) starts with a forte (*f*) dynamic and a handwritten note: *f + 2 + 3 + 4 +*. The bass line consists of eighth notes with various articulations (accents, slurs, and ties). Fingerings are indicated: 1, 4, 2, 4, 2, 1, and 5.

System 2 (Measures 4-6): The piano part begins in measure 4 with a sharp sign (#) on the first staff. The bass part continues with eighth notes. A mezzo-piano (*mp*) dynamic is marked in measure 5.

System 3 (Measures 7-9): The piano part has a forte (*f*) dynamic and a handwritten note: *f + 2 + 3 + 4 +*. The bass part continues with eighth notes. A piano (*p*) dynamic is marked in measure 8. Measure 9 shows a long slur in the piano part.

System 4 (Measures 10-12): The piano part has a piano (*p*) dynamic in measure 10 and a forte (*f*) dynamic in measure 12. The bass part continues with eighth notes. Measure 11 shows a long slur in the piano part.

13

mp

f

16

19

ff

No 8
Marcia trionfale

Triumphal march
from *Aida*

Giuseppe (Fortunino Francesco) Verdi
(1813 – 1901)
arranged John Brimhall

Tempo di marcia ♩ = 104

The first system of the musical score is in 4/4 time, marked 'Tempo di marcia' with a tempo of 104 beats per minute. It begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The melody starts with a quarter note G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note A4. A first ending bracket covers measures 2 and 3, which contain a half note G4 and a half note F#4. The melody continues with a quarter note E4, a quarter note D4, a quarter note C4, and a quarter note B3. A second ending bracket covers measures 4 and 5, which contain a half note A3 and a half note G3. The system concludes with a quarter note F#3 and a quarter note E3. The bass line consists of a series of chords: G3-B2, F#2-A2, E2-G2, D2-F#2, C2-E2, and B1-D2. The dynamic marking 'mf' is placed below the first measure.

The second system of the musical score continues the melody from the first system. It begins with a quarter note D4, a quarter note C4, a quarter note B3, and a quarter note A3. A first ending bracket covers measures 2 and 3, which contain a half note G3 and a half note F#3. The melody continues with a quarter note E3, a quarter note D3, a quarter note C3, and a quarter note B2. A second ending bracket covers measures 4 and 5, which contain a half note A2 and a half note G2. The system concludes with a quarter note F#2 and a quarter note E2. The bass line consists of a series of chords: G2-B1, F#1-A1, E1-G1, D1-F#1, C1-E1, and B0-D1. The dynamic marking 'mf' is placed below the first measure.

The third system of the musical score continues the melody from the second system. It begins with a quarter note D4, a quarter note C4, a quarter note B3, and a quarter note A3. A first ending bracket covers measures 2 and 3, which contain a half note G3 and a half note F#3. The melody continues with a quarter note E3, a quarter note D3, a quarter note C3, and a quarter note B2. A second ending bracket covers measures 4 and 5, which contain a half note A2 and a half note G2. The system concludes with a quarter note F#2 and a quarter note E2. The bass line consists of a series of chords: G2-B1, F#1-A1, E1-G1, D1-F#1, C1-E1, and B0-D1. The dynamic marking 'mp' is placed below the first measure.

Repeats are not required for examination purposes.

9

cresc.

12

f *mf*

14

16

No 9
The mad hatter
No 5 from Alice in Wonderland

Cecil Baumer
(1891 – died after 1965)

Allegretto ♩ = 20

3 2 3 2 4 2

mf marcato *f* *f* *f* *f*

1 3 2 4 1 3

6 3 2

f *legato*

5 1 2

11 3 2

5 1 2

16 5 2 5 2 5 2

sf *sf* *sf*

2 5 2 5 2 5

21

pp

mf

sf

5

2 3

26

sf

sempre pp

3 2

3 2

4 2

4 2

1 3

2 4

1 3

31

35

ritard.

f

ppp

4 2

4 2

4 2

2 3

2 4

1 5

No 10

Vic Mizzy
(born 1922)

arranged Dennis Alexander

Moderato⁽¹⁾

(snap fingers or tap piano lid)

(1) 

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12

2 2 3 4 1 2 1 3

1 2 5 1 3 2 4 1 3 1 2 5 1 3

15

3 4 2 2

2 4 1 3 1 2 5 1 3 3 3

18

1

3 3 3

21

3 4 1 2 1 3 4

2 4 1 3 1 2 5 1 3 2 4 1 3

24

3 2 5 1

1 2 5 3 1 5

PERFORMANCE NOTES

GRADE 1

No 1

Rag time

Christopher Norton

The quavers here are even, as written, and the general feel a little sedate. The piece should not be dull through stiffness, however, as rag time is dance music. Work for a delicate, precise sound, contrasting the smooth right-hand melody with the crisper *staccato* left hand. Don't be too heavy in accenting the 'off' quavers with which the phrases finish (bars 1 – 2, etc.) or the syncopated tie across the middle of the bar (bars 3, 7, etc.), as this will sound a little mannered. You have the choice to regard the opening phrases (bars 1 – 2) as containing a slight accent on the fourth quaver, or as tapering off towards the stronger third beat. Try it both ways, and see which you prefer. In the case of the longer lines, ensure that you convey the continuity of the whole melody. Subtle dynamic inflections are possible with the smallest melodic fragments – the trick is simply to keep them in balance with one another, and with the overall direction of the piece. An interesting moment occurs when what might have been expected as the conventional bass line has been transferred to the right hand in bar 4. A *decrescendo* here would be appropriate – amusing, even. Think about making the *da capo* quieter than it was at the beginning.

No 2

Dance

Béla Bartók

The chords in the left hand here are thick but must be played with a lightness appropriate to the dance-like nature of the piece. Accents are always relative to the dynamic indicated, so at the outset remember above all the *piano* stipulated and don't over-stress the first beats. The *mp* in bar 5 should refer more to the melody, rather than an overall increase in volume. Given the thickness of the accompaniment, it would be advisable to focus on bringing the melody out. The *staccato* should be light and crisp, but watch that the last note of bars such as 7 and 19 aren't clipped since they aren't marked *staccato*. Dynamic indications are pretty spare, but that is probably because the melody is written to make your choices obvious. The repeat of the melody from bar 13 might be a little louder as greater harmonic complexity ensues in the following bars. The *calando* at bars 19 – 21 shouldn't be sudden. You will probably be on a downward dynamic incline already, given the falling melody. The asymmetry here mustn't seem uncomfortable; bars 21 – 22 are 'extra' to the symmetrical manner in which the piece has been unfolding (four-bar introduction, repeated eight-bar melody), and you will need to build them into your understanding of the work. *Calando* goes all the way to the barline, evenly becoming slower and softer. Make the final fifths in the left hand as quiet as you possibly can, while preserving clarity of attack and evenness as the tempo slows.

No 3

The ambling armadillo

Robert Keane

Expression marks are kept to a minimum in the first four bars, but given the nature of bars 4 and 5, you might take a few more liberties with articulation here. If the opening bars are all *legato*, then the *staccato* of the first beat in bar 5 will seem to come out of nowhere. Repeated notes (beats 3 – 4 of bar 1, beats 1 – 2 of bar 3) cannot be played *legato*, but that of course

doesn't mean they'll have to be short and sharp either. Consider the degree to which bars 5 – 6 will contrast with bars 1 – 4. The left hand seems more likely to be *legato* except where explicitly indicated; however, there is the possibility that the last two beats of bar 7 in the right hand might be answered by the first two beats of the following bar in the left. These decisions are matters of interpretation and, as such, are up to you. The *forte* in the final bar should be louder still than the end of the *crescendo* just played.

No 4

Groovy movie

Elissa Milne

The harmonic framework of this piece should be familiar, since it is a twelve-bar blues form expanded by the doubling of individual bars (to make 24 bars). The $\frac{6}{8}$ time signature carries a built-in swing feel, the three quavers of the dotted crotchet beat being essentially the same as triplets in a crotchet. Work on creating a feeling of smooth mobility in the quaver lines. Although the opening bars seem a little jerky, the quavers should flow so that we feel the dotted crotchet beats – or even just the beginning of the bars – as the main pulses. 'Groovy' is the term used to describe playing that demonstrates an infectious dance sensibility, so that you click your fingers, or tap your foot, or just 'feel it'. Groove is one of the most undeniably powerful elements of music: it exists in Bach, in Ravel, even in Wagner, and it lives perhaps most strongly – it's certainly most easily traced – in popular music. It's not something that you can will to happen in performance, but you can seek it while you prepare and gradually be more certain that it will emerge when you play. It should not sound like you're working hard to make it happen; rather that it were the most natural consequence of the urge that produces music. It's an unhurried, unfussy, unforced thing that you just need to listen for and then enjoy.

No 5

Ol' rockin' chair blues

Martha Mier

An unhurried feel is the key here. Keeping a steady swing pulse in the left hand, without any sense of acceleration – but certainly without dragging either – is essential to the success of this piece. Remember the importance of not making your swing feel stilted in any way by making the first quaver too long. The right-hand melody seems to take up from the left when it enters, and so it must also be in your rhythmic sense. Although the right hand moves between one and two parts, work for continuity in the melody, bringing the top notes out a little more brightly so their link with what has preceded is clear. Be sparing with the louder dynamics, since these can make the effort audible above the effect. *Mezzo-forte* is the loudest dynamic called for in the score, but there are moments such as the accent at bar 18 where you may feel a little more power is called for. This piece is really about a relaxed feel and your dynamics should reflect it. It's a good idea to start to ascertain what kind of power can be generated by swing without excessive dynamics – what kind of energy you can create while playing quietly.

No 6

TV zombie

Sonny Chua

Once again, here we have duplet quavers, triplets, and the dotted quaver/semiquaver pairing that is so often used as shorthand for swing. Given the nature of the left hand at the outset – in the manner of a walking bass line – a jazz inflection seems to be suggested in which the dotted quavers at the end of the second bar would be more appropriately rendered as a triplet

subdivision of the crotchet. The first two notes of the next bar, then, would be similar: two plus one triplet quavers in the time of a crotchet, with the quaver tied to the second beat. Exceptions to the swung rhythm occur in bars 6 and 8 where even quavers appear on the second beat of the bar as the phrase ends. Given the rather insistent triplets in the left hand in bar 8, this seems slightly odd, but it could be an effort to 'draw out' the rhythm at the end of the phrase, in a kind of bending of the pulse. The melody will need to be brightly articulated from the outset, as when the left hand becomes more weighty (bars 8 – 9) and the right is in a higher register, the stress required for it to be properly prominent should not constitute a great change from what has preceded. The left hand shouldn't be too loud, given its texture. A steady pulse is most obviously necessary when there is silence (as in bar 13), a tie across the barline (bars 15 – 16) or a long, held note (bars 20 – 21). The pulse will have to have been established as steady from the beginning for these moments to be meaningful. eighty beats a minute is not fast, but groove is possible at any tempo and that is what you should seek.

No 7

Garage sale

Pamela Wedgwood

The contrasting dynamics are a pleasing aspect of this piece, which works within the familiar style of heavy rock. The accents within the opening left-hand line, however, indicate clearly that not all the notes are to be stressed equally. Don't hurry with this piece – the tempo must be steady for the syncopations to work. Syncopations include the ties across barlines (bars 1 – 2, 3 – 4, etc.) and displacements of accent within the bar (bars 7 and 18 in particular). Hurrying would also destroy the effect of the brief silence at the end of bar 8, or the held note in bar 14, so count carefully through these. The accent on the fourth quaver in these bars (explicitly indicated or not) displaces the accent usually felt on the third beat, and it is possible that your counting of the remaining beats may be abbreviated – just be on the lookout for this as a rhythmically destabilising possibility. Work the contrasting dynamics as much as you can, exploiting them – even the *piano* that follows silence at the beginning of bar 9 should be something of a surprise. As the quietest moment yet in the piece, it's unexpected. The reply in the left hand in the following bar demonstrates that things haven't actually changed all that much. Played strongly and placed accurately in the bar, this will be most effective. Measure your *decrescendo* in bars 19 – 20 very carefully, bringing the volume well back so that the *ff* chord in the final bar is once again a great contrast.

No 8

Marcia trionfale

Giuseppe (Fortunino Francesco) Verdi

The melody essentially covers a small range during the A section of this piece. You can use dynamic change to bring great interest to the line. Look at the manner in which Verdi uses the notes G, A and B between bars 3 and 6 – stressing each of them on different occasions and in the process changing their meaning from bar to bar. Even within bar 5, the stressed B occurs twice, the first time on a tonic chord, then on a secondary dominant. Subtle changes of colour – nothing too dramatic! – through these bars will demonstrate your understanding of the music's direction, and contribute to its overall effect. The B section melody contrasts with that of the A section both through its broader range and larger, more strident intervals. Yet it is cast at the outset as *mp*, whereas the opening was *mf*. Measure the *crescendo* throughout this section carefully, and bear in mind that at the end of bar 12 you will be dropping back from the *forte* achieved to the *mf* of the A section. Determine your tempo with great care and at all costs avoid hurrying. Bring shape to the left-hand accompaniment as well. Outline the bass notes in the 'stride' pattern of bars 3 – 4 and consider slight *crescendi* in bars 9 and 10 to emphasise the motion to the tonic minor.

No 9

The mad hatter

Cecil Baumer

There are some tricky things in this piece. In the first four bars, the *staccato* needs to be very crisp and the notes to speak together. Be prepared for the unexpected and sudden jump from *mf* to *f*. The *legato* in bars 9 – 16 is an obvious point of contrast. The sections being repeated are also reduced from four to two bars in length as a further contrast. You might like to consider an overall *crescendo* to bar 17 in addition to the *crescendo* and *decrescendo* patterns indicated, although this is a matter of your own interpretation of the music. Bars 21 – 24 echo bars 17 – 20, and bars 25 – 26 are a refreshing ‘one-off’. The recapitulation is challenging in a new way given that the composer has called for *pp* throughout. What to do about *tenuto* here is an interesting question. Since the repeated chord in bar 29 can’t be played *legato*, the ‘neither *staccato* nor *legato*’ idea doesn’t seem to hold completely. The greatest challenge in the whole piece is the last four bars: the sudden *f*, then a *ritard.* and *diminuendo* over all of a bar, to *ppp*. This requires enormous presence of mind and control and will not be easy to put across. But it can be done, and it will repay all the work you put into it.

No 10

The Addams family theme

Vic Mizzy

The triplets in the left hand should be very smooth: a glide up to the top note of each phrase. Perhaps you could contrast slightly the repeat of the first four bars by making it a little quieter. At any rate, when the melody enters, it won’t need to be particularly loud. Notice here that one of the melody notes in the majority of phrases is taken by the left hand. There should not be any audible ‘dip’ or break in the melodic flow owing to unevenness between the hands. The melody note should be the one we hear of the two being played by the left hand, so as to preserve continuity. This means also that there will be a slight differentiation between the first and second top notes in the left hand part, for example in bar 9, the B and the C. There are no dynamic indications after the first *mf* but obviously you’ll need to think the dynamics through in terms of individual phrases, the theme as a whole (e.g. bars 9 – 12) and the three statements of this theme. Also think about the way dynamics might shape the introductory material (as suggested above) and its reappearance (bar 17 ff). Since your interpretation is all but solicited by the absence of explicit directions, think about how you want the ending to go. You could choose either a *crescendo* or a *decrescendo* and make either one work, depending simply on your taste and preference.

Performance notes by

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